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Beyond Motivation: Modeling the Predictive Role of L2 Pride in Informal Digital Learning of English

Minlin Minny Zou¹  | Guangxiang Leon Liu²  | Dan Li¹ | Huiqing Chen³

¹School of Education, University of Exeter, Exeter, United Kingdom | ²Department of English, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Hong Kong SAR, China |

³School of Education, Hunan University of Science and Technology, Xiangtan, China

Correspondence: Guangxiang Leon Liu (G.Liu@link.cuhk.edu.hk)

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ABSTRACT

This study investigates the role of second language (L2) pride—an understudied affective factor—in shaping learners' language learning motivation and involvement with informal digital learning of English (IDLE). Drawing on questionnaire data from 1388 Chinese university EFL students, the study employs structural equation modeling to examine the relationships between L2 pride, L2 motivational self-system components (ideal L2 self and ought-to L2 self), and IDLE practices. Results reveal that L2 pride directly influences both students' IDLE participation and their ideal and ought-to L2 selves. Furthermore, both components of the L2 motivation partially mediate the relationship between L2 pride and IDLE participation. These findings highlight the importance of pedagogically nurturing students' emotional experiences as proud L2 learners and fostering clear L2 self-images to promote autonomous engagement in informal language learning within digital environments.

摘要

本研究探讨了第二语言(L2)自豪感—一种未被充分研究的情感因素—在影响学习者语言学习动机和参与非正式英语数字化学习(IDLE)中的作用。本研究利用1388名中国大学EFL学生的问卷调查数据,采用结构方程模型研究了第二语言自豪感、第二语言动机自我系统成分(理想的第二语言自我和应该的第二语言自我)和IDLE实践之间的关系。结果表明, L2 自豪感直接影响学生的 IDLE 参与及其理想的和应该的 L2 自我。此外, 语言学习动机的两个组成部分在一定程度上调节了语言学习自豪感与 IDLE 参与之间的关系。这些发现凸显了在教学中培养学生作为自豪的 L2 学习者的情感体验以及培养清晰的 L2 自我形象对于促进学生在数字环境中自主参与非正式语言学习的重要性。

1 | Introduction

The accelerated global mobility facilitated by the prevalence of digital technologies has rendered substantial and ample chances for second language (L2) learners to engage with the target language beyond the classroom (Liu 2023). In light of this

background, informal digital learning of English (IDLE hereafter) has emerged and received close attention from applied linguists within the recent decade. IDLE refers to self-guided, self-directed, and autonomous language learning activities (e.g., browsing English content on social media) that learners undertake through digital devices and online resources outside formal educational

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settings (Lai et al. 2015; Lai and Wang 2024; Lee and Dressman 2018; Soyoo et al. 2023). Recent scholarship has increasingly recognized that individual differences, particularly motivational and affective factors, play crucial roles in determining learners' engagement with IDLE practices (Lee and Drajiati 2019; Lee and Lee 2020; Liu et al. 2024).

Research has extensively documented how motivational factors, particularly the L2 motivational self-system, drive dedicated IDLE behaviors (Lee and Lu 2023; Liu et al. 2024, Liu et al. 2024). However, the role of affective variables as emotional anchors that sustain IDLE learners' motivation remains understudied, despite evidence that positive emotional experiences create self-reinforcing cycles of engagement and achievement in language learning (Fathi et al. 2024). Among these affective variables, L2 pride emerges as a particularly promising yet underexplored factor in empowering learning behaviors and academic engagement through its enhancement of learners' sense of accomplishment and self-efficacy (Yang and Li 2024). The significance of L2 pride in IDLE contexts manifests in several key dimensions. As a self-conscious emotion, L2 pride distinctively emerges from personal achievements and social recognition in language learning. Unlike more general and situation-dependent affective variables such as enjoyment, anxiety, or boredom, L2 pride specifically connects to learners' sense of accomplishment and self-worth in relation to their language learning journey. This unique characteristic positions L2 pride as especially relevant for understanding motivated behaviors and engagement in IDLE contexts. The relationship between L2 pride and learning motivation finds strong theoretical grounding in both the control-value theory of achievement emotions (Pekrun 2006) and the L2 motivational self system (L2MSS; Dörnyei 2009). As a positive achievement emotion, L2 pride may enhance learners' promotion-oriented motivation, reinforce their ideal L2 selves, and foster engagement in IDLE activities aligned with their language learning aspirations. This theoretical foundation illuminates the conceptual significance of L2 pride in driving motivation and engagement within digital learning environments. Beyond its immediate relevance to IDLE contexts, this investigation of L2 pride carries broader implications for L2 learning and positive psychology. It enriches the growing literature on positive emotions in language learning (Dewaele and MacIntyre 2014; Kaiqi and Kutuk 2024; Ma et al. 2024) while advancing the positive psychology movement's emphasis on promoting well-being and optimal functioning in educational settings (Seligman and Csikszentmihalyi 2000). This positioning within wider disciplinary contexts underscores the study's significance in exploring the novel dimension of L2 pride.

The gap in understanding the interplay between L2 pride and motivation takes on particular significance in the research context of IDLE, where successful IDLE learners must sustain their participation in English literacy and communication practices in an independent and proactive way (Liu and Darvin 2024). On this ground, while IDLE offers unprecedented opportunities for autonomous learning, it also demands greater emotional resilience and sustained motivation from learners. Understanding how L2 pride contributes to this emotional foundation and motivational dynamics could provide crucial insights for developing more effective pedagogical interventions that prepare learners for autonomous involvement with IDLE. To address this gap, this paper examines the following question:

RQ: In what ways, if any, does L2 pride interplay with L2 motivation to predict EFL learners' participation in IDLE?

2 | Literature Review

This section reviews the key notions involved in the present research and potential cause-effect mechanisms that help formulate the research hypotheses.

2.1 | Informal Digital Learning of English

At the intersection of computer-assisted language learning (CALL) and informal language learning (Dressman and Sadler 2020; Lai et al. 2015; Liu and Wang 2024; Soyoo et al. 2023; Zhang and Liu 2022), IDLE has emerged as a burgeoning field of study in L2 education. A substantial body of research has documented the multifaceted benefits of IDLE engagement for language learners (Sundqvist and Uztosun 2024; Zhang and Liu 2023). These benefits span three key domains: linguistic development, motivational enhancement, and psychological well-being. Studies have demonstrated that IDLE participation strengthens learners' linguistic competence (Lee 2019; Lee and Dressman 2018; Sundqvist and Uztosun 2024), and bolsters their language learning motivation (Lee and Lu 2023; Liu et al. 2024). In terms of affective outcomes, IDLE has been shown to closely relate to language learning enjoyment (Liu et al. 2024, Liu et al. 2024), foster self-efficacy (Zadorozhnyy and Lee 2023), build language confidence and L2 grit (Azari Noughabi and Ghasemi 2024), while reducing language anxiety (Lee and Drajiati 2019). Moreover, research indicates that IDLE strengthens learners' intercultural competence (Lee 2020; Liu et al. 2023) and L2 communication behaviors (Lee and Lu 2023; Liu 2025). In summary, these empirical investigations have demonstrated that IDLE has emerged as a crucial component within contemporary L2 pedagogy. This development is situated within an increasingly digitized educational landscape, wherein learners are afforded opportunities to engage in self-directed language learning through enhanced technological accessibility. As digital technologies continue to evolve and become more accessible, IDLE is likely to play an increasingly important part in shaping the future of L2 learning, particularly in fostering learner autonomy and self-directed learning.

2.2 | L2 Pride

L2 pride, a dominant affective factor that serves as a pivotal motivational force in academic settings (Barabadi and Khajavy 2020), is conceptualized as "a complicated emotion, activating, directing, and motivating investments and efforts toward reaching achievement goals" (Buechner et al. 2016, p. 181). This emotion typically emerges during mastery experiences throughout the L2 learning process. Also noted is that the conceptual understanding of pride has evolved through systematic categorization. Initially, Buechner et al. (2016) identified two predominant types: self-based pride and social comparison-based pride in education in general. Building on this framework, Khajavy and Lüftenegger (2024) developed and validated a more nuanced categorization specific to foreign language learning contexts, comprising four

dimensions: (a) **Self-based pride**: emanating from personal learning accomplishments; (b) **Social comparison-based pride**: arising from outperforming peers or classmates; (c) **Praise-based pride**: stemming from recognition and encouragement by teachers, parents, or peers; (d) **Help-based pride**: emerging from supporting others in their language development. According to Pekrun's (2006) control-value theory of achievement emotions, L2 pride can be characterized as a retrospective, positive, outcome-oriented emotion that arises when learners attribute significant achievements to internal factors. Research has demonstrated that experiences of L2 pride can have lasting effects on learners' language development trajectories. These effects include enhanced language achievement, increased willingness to communicate in English (Ross and Stracke 2016), strengthened learning motivation (Barabadi and Khajavy 2020), and sustained language learning enjoyment (Derakhshan and Yin 2024). To conclude, these existing studies have highlighted the potential of L2 pride as a valuable construct in second language acquisition (SLA) research and pedagogy, particularly given its long-term impact on learners' language development trajectories.

2.3 | Formulating the Hypotheses

This study integrates two theoretical frameworks to examine L2 motivation and pride in digital learning contexts. Drawing upon Dörnyei's (2009) L2MSS, we conceptualize the core dynamics of L2 motivation. We complement this with Pekrun's (2006) control-value theory of achievement emotions to investigate the interplay between L2 pride, motivation, and language learning behaviors in out-of-class digital environments. Building on existing empirical evidence, we then elaborate the potential causal mechanisms that inform our hypotheses.

2.3.1 | Theoretical Framework

Dörnyei's (2009) L2MSS is often positioned as one of the most influential and widely adopted models for operationalizing and understanding L2 learners' motivational constructs (Lee and Lu 2023; Wang et al. 2024; Yung and Chiu 2023). The L2MSS is anchored by two primary components: the ideal L2 self and the ought-to L2 self. The ideal L2 self represents learners' aspirational future self-image, encompassing both integrative motives (desire to integrate into the target language community) and instrumental motives (personal achievement goals) in language learning (Dörnyei 2009). This construct functions as a powerful motivator by encouraging learners to minimize the discrepancy between their current and desired future L2 selves. In contrast, the ought-to L2 self is shaped by extrinsic factors and represents the attributes that learners believe they should possess to meet expectations and avoid negative outcomes. This dimension is particularly salient when learners strive to fulfil parental expectations or succeed in high-stakes examinations, as the fear of disappointing others or facing adverse consequences can drive efforts in language learning. Also, the distinction between these two components lies in their regulatory focus: while the ideal L2 self is promotion oriented, centered on achieving aspirations and positive outcomes, the ought-to L2 self is prevention oriented, focused on avoiding negative consequences and meeting external expectations (Yung and Chiu 2023).

While L2MSS primarily addresses self-images and future-oriented motivations, the control-value theory of achievement emotions (Pekrun 2006) offers a complementary perspective by highlighting the role of affective factors in shaping motivation and learning behaviors. Within educational psychology, affective factors like pride are typically understood as motivational antecedents. Specifically, Pekrun's theory posits that positive emotions such as pride enhance motivation by increasing both the value learners attribute to tasks and their perceived control over outcomes. This enhancement of perceived control is particularly crucial in self-directed learning environments, where learners must maintain their motivation without consistent external guidance. In L2 learning contexts, pride in one's language abilities may serve a dual function: it strengthens the ideal L2 self by reinforcing positive self-images while simultaneously supporting the ought-to L2 self by aligning with external expectations. The reciprocal relationship between pride and self-efficacy creates a positive feedback loop, where successful learning experiences generate pride, which in turn motivates further engagement with challenging language tasks.

2.3.2 | The Cause-Effect Mechanism of L2 Pride and IDLE

While research exploring the relationship between L2 pride and IDLE remains limited, several studies have demonstrated L2 pride's positive influence on learners' linguistic competence and academic engagement (Barabadi and Khajavy 2020; Derakhshan and Yin 2024; Gatbonton and Trofimovich 2008; Yang and Li 2024). Specifically, the relationship between L2 pride and academic engagement has been substantiated through several empirical studies. In a large-scale study of 2008 Iranian secondary students, Barabadi and Khajavy (2020) examined how perfectionism, emotions (including pride), and achievement goals influenced foreign language achievement. While not directly investigating pride's predictive role in achievement, their findings revealed strong correlations between positive emotions and L2 English achievement. Similarly, Derakhshan and Yin (2024) conducted a comparative study of 346 Chinese and 353 Iranian tertiary EFL students using maximum variation sampling. Their structural equation modeling (SEM) analysis revealed that L2 pride, along with hope and enjoyment, significantly predicted academic engagement across both EFL contexts. Given the established relationship between L2 pride and academic engagement in formal learning environments, this causal mechanism may extend to extramural language learning contexts. Extramural language learning refers to language learning activities that take place outside of formal educational settings, such as classroom instruction (Sundqvist and Uztosun 2024). While IDLE specifically pertains to informal digital learning activities, extramural learning encompasses a broader spectrum of out-of-class learning experiences, incorporating both digital and non-digital activities. These may include reading English books, watching English films, or engaging in face-to-face interactions with native English speakers.

Furthermore, L2 pride appears to function as a significant predictor of learning behaviors, serving as a sustained motivator that drives their participation in learning practices within the classroom (Yang and Li 2024). In out-of-class digital learning

environments, IDLE also opens up authentic language learning contexts and diverse online communication opportunities, which enable learners to develop a sense of pride in their identity as legitimate English users regardless of their identity inscriptions (e.g., rural vs. urban, see Liu and Darvin 2024). Out-of-class digital learning environments are broadly understood as diverse online platforms and digital resources that are utilized by learners to facilitate language acquisition beyond formal educational settings (Lai et al. 2015). Such environments encompass a wide range of digital tools, including social media, online forums, language learning applications, and video-sharing platforms, among others. Building upon such empirical evidence, we propose the following hypothesis:

H 1. *L2 pride positively predicts IDLE.*

2.3.3 | The Cause–Effect Mechanisms of L2 Pride and L2 Motivation

Research specifically examining the relationship between L2 pride and L2 motivation is very limited (MacIntyre and Vincze 2017). However, broader literature has established pride's significant motivational influence across various contexts (Utz and Muscanell 2018). MacIntyre and Vincze (2017) conducted a foundational study among Italian monolingual secondary school students in Bolzano/Bozen, investigating the relationships between emotional factors (including 9 negative and 10 positive emotions) and motivational constructs (including ideal L2 self and ought-to L2 self). Their findings revealed consistent and significant correlations between positive emotions (including pride) and motivational variables throughout the L2 learning process. In addition, focusing on the EFL writing context, Wang et al. (2024) conducted a sequential mixed-methods study ($N = 360$) examining how positive emotions (including enjoyment, hope, and pride) mediate the relationship between L2 motivation and self-regulated learning (SRL) in L2 writing. Their research results demonstrated that while the ideal L2 self predicted positive emotions, positive emotions cannot mediate the relationship between ought-to L2 self and SRL. Further theoretical support comes from Sznycer and Cohen's (2021) cross-cultural investigation of pride's neurocognitive guidance system in the United States and India. Their research revealed that pride facilitates cost-effective achievement pursuit by calibrating efforts to potential social benefits, thereby promoting achievements that others value. Given this established relationship between pride and motivation across different domains, we propose the following two hypotheses regarding the relationship between L2 pride and L2 motivation:

H 2. *L2 pride positively predicts the ideal L2 self.*

H 3. *L2 pride positively predicts the ought-to L2 self.*

2.3.4 | The Cause–Effect Mechanisms of L2 Motivation and IDLE

Several studies have investigated the predictive relationship between L2 motivation and participation in IDLE practices (Lee

and Lu 2023; Liu 2024; Liu et al. 2025), providing empirical foundations for hypotheses regarding the motivational mechanisms underlying IDLE involvement. The findings from this line of scholarship demonstrated that learners with well-developed ideal L2 self-images were more likely to experience enjoyment in their English learning journey, subsequently facilitating greater involvement in IDLE activities within unstructured digital environments. Given that L2 motivation has been consistently identified as a crucial driver of autonomous language learning in digital contexts (Lai et al. 2015; Lee and Lu 2023; Li et al. 2022), we propose the following two hypotheses:

H 4. *Ideal L2 self positively predicts IDLE.*

H 5. *Ought-to L2 self positively predicts IDLE.*

Taken together, the five hypotheses that may help to address the research question are demonstrated in Figure 1.

3 | Methodology

3.1 | Research Context and Participants

This study was conducted in the Chinese university EFL context, with participants recruited from 10 public universities in South China. Participant recruitment employed a convenience sampling approach through online channels. The research team disseminated an e-poster containing a QR code for the online survey via WeChat, a prominent Chinese social media platform. Additionally, the fourth author collaborated with 30 university teachers who assisted in distributing the questionnaire to their students between September and November 2024. These teachers were briefed on the research objectives and subsequently communicated the purpose of the study to their students. Participants were required to meet two essential criteria: (1) current enrollment as an undergraduate student at a Chinese university; (2) status as an English as a foreign language (EFL) learner.

There were 1388 Chinese university undergraduate students (1004 female and 384 male) who completed the online questionnaire from different regions across China. The large share of respondents ($N = 1150$, 82.8%) were aged between 18 and 20, with a smaller proportion ($N = 37$, 2.6%) aged 21–22. Additionally, 201 participants (14.4%) were younger than 18. These students were enrolled in diverse subject disciplines, including Arts and Humanities (e.g., English) ($N = 381$, 27.4%), Social Sciences ($N = 251$, 18.0%), STEM ($N = 356$, 25.6%), Business and Management ($N = 110$, 7.9%), Health Sciences ($N = 65$, 4.6%), and other fields ($N = 225$, 16.2%). Regarding digital device ownership, over half of the participants ($N = 983$, 70.8%) reported using two types of digital devices (e.g., a smartphone and a laptop), while 187 students (13.4%) owned only a single smartphone. Additionally, 177 respondents (12.7%) reported utilizing three types of devices (e.g., a smartphone, a laptop, and a tablet), and 41 participants (2.9%) owned more than three types of devices. With respect to Wi-Fi accessibility, the majority ($N = 967$, 69.6%) reported having access to stable Wi-Fi, whereas 421 participants (30.4%) indicated challenges in securing a reliable Internet connection.

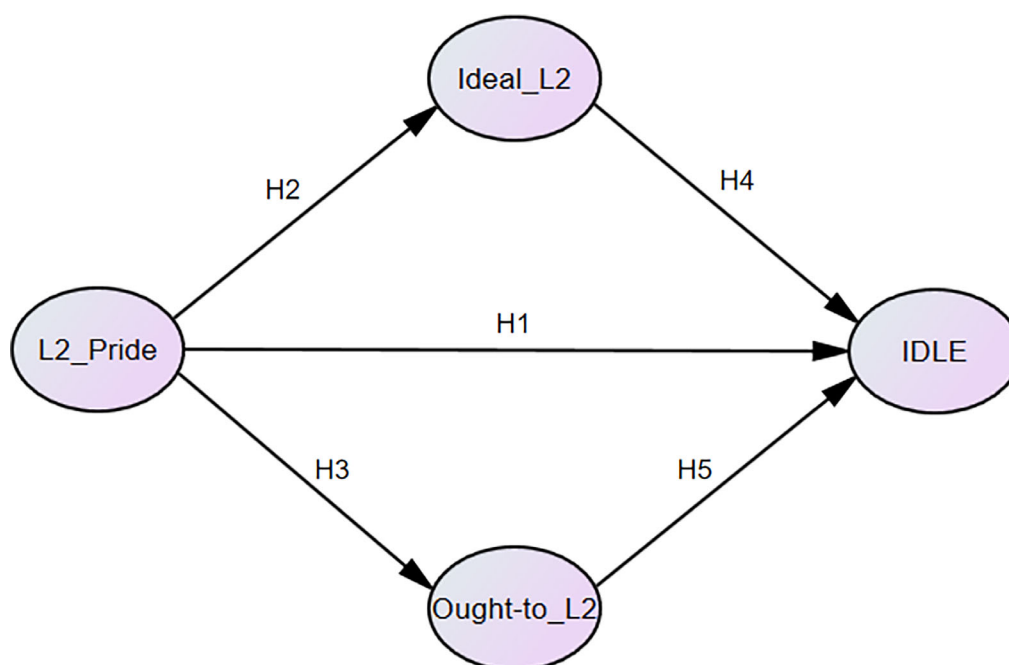


FIGURE 1 | The hypothesized structural model. [Color figure can be viewed at [wileyonlinelibrary.com](https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/10.1111/ijal.12738)]

3.2 | Data Collection and Analysis

Data collection was conducted using a modified 46-item questionnaire administered through Wenjuanxing, a Chinese online survey platform (see Appendix A, B, and C). The questionnaire was originally developed in English and then translated into Chinese for administration to our target population of Chinese EFL learners. To ensure the accuracy and equivalence of the translated questionnaire, we followed a rigorous translation and validation process: (a) Initial translation: The questionnaire items were initially translated from English to Chinese by two bilingual researchers with expertise in applied linguistics and language education; (b) Back-translation: The Chinese version of the questionnaire was then back-translated into English by a third bilingual researcher who was not involved in the initial translation process. The accuracy of back-translation was 94%; (c) Comparison and refinement: The original English items, the translated Chinese items, and the back-translated English items were systematically compared by the research team to identify any discrepancies or inconsistencies. Revisions were made to the Chinese translation to ensure that the intended meaning of each item was accurately conveyed. As a result of this process, the final version of the Chinese questionnaire was established. The Chinese questionnaire began with a mandatory consent question; only participants who indicated their agreement to participate by selecting “Yes” were permitted to proceed to the main survey. The main survey consisted of two sections: demographic information and psychometric scales. The scales section comprised 46 items measuring three constructs: L2 pride, L2 motivation, and IDLE involvement. All items were rated on a six-point Likert scale, with responses ranging from 1 (strongly disagree) to 6 (strongly agree). The specific components of these scales are detailed below.

- (a) L2 pride (20 items): To assess L2 pride among Chinese EFL learners, this study employed Khajavy and Lüftenegger’s (2024) psychometrically validated L2 pride scale. This multi-

dimensional instrument measures four distinct facets of L2 pride, each demonstrating high internal consistency (Cronbach’s $\alpha = 0.94\text{--}0.96$): self-based pride, social comparison-based pride, praise-based pride, and help-based pride. Self-based pride, as conceptualized by Buechner et al. (2016) and elaborated by Khajavy and Lüftenegger (2024), captures learners’ sense of self-worth and accomplishment derived from personal growth in L2 acquisition. This dimension is measured through items such as “I am proud when I speak English more fluently in the classroom than before.” Social comparison-based pride reflects learners’ feelings of pride when outperforming peers in L2 acquisition (Buechner et al. 2016; Khajavy and Lüftenegger 2024). This construct is assessed through items like “I am proud when I can speak English better than my classmates.” Praise-based pride encompasses feelings of self-worth arising from public recognition and accolades, which foster perseverance and effort investment in L2 learning (Khajavy and Lüftenegger 2024). A representative item is “I am proud when my English teacher praises me in the classroom.” Help-based pride captures the sense of pride derived from assisting others and engaging in prosocial behaviors within L2 learning contexts (Khajavy and Lüftenegger 2024). This dimension is measured through items such as “I am proud when I can help my classmates in their English course.”

- (b) L2 motivation (12 items): To measure the ideal and ought-to L2 selves of Chinese L2 English learners, the present study employed the L2MSS scales originally developed by Dörnyei (2009) and subsequently validated by You et al. (2016) in the context of Chinese learners. The content validity of the scales was established through consultation with a panel of three experienced researchers in the field of CALL. After this process, six items were retained for the ideal L2 self variable (Cronbach’s $\alpha = 0.93$), indicating a high level of internal consistency. One example item is, “I can imagine myself

doing business with foreigners through English.” Similarly, the ought-to L2 self scale showed a good internal consistency (Cronbach’s $\alpha = 0.88$), comprising six items. One example item is, “I consider learning English important because I want to be recognized by my teachers and classmates.”

- (c) IDLE (14 items): To conceptualize and operationalize IDLE, we developed a measurement scale by synthesizing prior literature (e.g., Lai and Wang 2024; Lee 2020a, 2020b; Lee and Dressman 2018; Sundqvist and Uztosun 2024). The resulting 14-item scale, validated for content validity, measures two dimensions of IDLE engagement: form-focused activities (Cronbach’s $\alpha = 0.93$) and meaning-focused activities (Cronbach’s $\alpha = 0.92$). Form-focused IDLE activities encompass technology-mediated English learning tasks conducted outside the classroom that emphasize formal linguistic elements, including grammatical structures, lexical items, phonological features, and syntactic patterns. These activities are represented by items such as “I actively use mobile phone apps or websites to learn English grammar outside of class.” Meaning-focused IDLE activities comprise technology-mediated English learning tasks beyond the classroom that develop comprehension skills, communicative competence, and pragmatic language use in authentic contexts. This dimension is measured through items like “I actively read English articles online or English-related posts on social media.”

Employing SPSS 29.0 and AMOS 26.0, we used a SEM approach to analyze the survey data by following five main procedures (Collier 2020; Kline 2023). First, data cleaning and screening were conducted by checking for outliers, missing values, and invalid questionnaires with short-time responses (i.e., lower than 1 min). Second, the normality of the data was assessed by testing each item’s skewness and kurtosis. Means and standard deviations of the questionnaire’s items were calculated which were reported in descriptive statistics. Third, Cronbach’s alpha (α) was utilized to assess the internal consistency (i.e., reliability) of the sub-scales. Fourth, a thorough confirmatory factor analysis (CFA) was done to check the validity of each factor in the instruments. Lastly, the complete structural model was established and validated to explore the interrelationships among L2 pride, L2 motivation, and IDLE.

4 | Research Findings

This section reports key findings from data analysis. To begin with, descriptive statistics shows the general profiles of L2 pride, L2 motivation, and involvement in IDLE activities of Chinese university EFL undergraduate students. Subsequently, the reliability and validity of the data was checked. Finally, this section moves toward the results of structural model and mediation model analysis and emphasizes the major findings that tackle the research question.

4.1 | Descriptive Statistics

In Table 1, the descriptive statistics displayed respondents’ self-perception of L2 pride, L2 motivation level, and frequency of participating in IDLE activities. Specifically, the mean of all items

fluctuated between 3.06 and 4.71, which generally suggested that participants had a strong sense of L2 pride, clear ideal L2 self, and ought-to L2 self images. They are also involved in IDLE activities in relatively frequent situations. The span of standard deviations of these items (i.e., from 0.99 to 1.30) indicated that the variability of the data was acceptable. Based on the recommendation of Kline (2023), kurtosis and skewness values of each item met the recommended domains of $<|8|$ and $<|3|$, respectively (see Table 1), which disclosed that the dataset did not substantially deviate from normality.

4.2 | Reliability and Validity Testing

As shown in Table 1, the Cronbach’s α values of eight variables were 0.96 (self-based pride), 0.96 (praise-based pride), 0.94 (social comparison-based pride), 0.96 (help-based pride), 0.93 (ideal L2 self), 0.88 (ought-to L2 self), 0.93 (form-focused IDLE), and 0.92 (meaning-focused IDLE), which all outperformed the recommended threshold of 0.7 (Kline 2023), thus indicating that the internal consistency was achieved.

With regard to the validity checking, convergent and discriminant validity were calculated. As Collier (2020) suggested, the composite reliability (CR) and the average variance extracted (AVE) of each variable were employed to measure the establishment of convergent validity. In Table 2, the CRs of four factors exceeded the benchmark value 0.7, and the AVEs of four factors were higher than the cut-off value 0.5 (Hair et al. 2009). The discriminant validity was examined by the square root of AVE of each factor and their respective inter-factor correlation coefficients (Hair et al. 2009). As displayed in Table 2, the square roots of AVE were all higher than their corresponding correlation coefficients, indicating the accomplishment of discriminant validity.

In addition, a measurement model that comprised four factors and their respective observed variables was utilized to strengthen the construct validity of the modified questionnaire in AMOS. There were eight indices to decide the model fit degree between the measurement model and the dataset, encompassing the ratio of χ^2 to degrees of freedom (χ^2/df), comparative fit index (CFI), incremental fit index (IFI), Tucker–Lewis index (TLI), normed fit index (NFI), parsimony goodness-of-fit index (PGFI), root mean square error of approximation (RMSEA), and standardized root mean squared residual (SRMR). As presented in Table 3, a goodness model fit between the measurement model and the dataset was achieved because, except for χ^2/df , which is very sensitive to sample size, all model indices met the suggested ranges. Therefore, it can be verified that the questionnaire data demonstrated excellent construct validity.

4.3 | The Structural Equation Model and Mediation Model Measurement

To test the hypotheses, SEM analysis was conducted using AMOS software. The structural model demonstrated good fit indices (see Table 3), meeting all recommended thresholds (Collier 2020). Path analysis results from the structural model (Table 4) supported all five hypothesized relationships. To be specific, L2 pride was able to make a positive, direct, and significant impact

TABLE 1 | Descriptive statistics.

Factors	Items	Mean	SD	Kurtosis	Skewness	Factor loading (In CFA)	α (>0.7)
Self-based pride	SB1	4.59	1.08	1.63	−1.08	0.85	0.96
	SB2	4.70	1.02	1.95	−1.12	0.89	
	SB3	4.70	1.04	2.04	−1.17	0.92	
	SB4	4.71	1.03	2.17	−1.15	0.92	
	SB5	4.70	1.05	1.84	−1.09	0.92	
Praise-based pride	PB1	4.66	1.02	1.85	−1.05	0.90	0.96
	PB2	4.60	1.03	1.56	−0.97	0.91	
	PB3	4.68	1.01	1.76	−1.01	0.92	
	PB4	4.69	1.00	2.04	−1.08	0.92	
	PB5	4.71	0.99	2.11	−1.07	0.92	
Social comparison-based pride	SC1	4.40	1.17	0.65	−0.86	0.79	0.94
	SC2	4.60	1.07	1.43	−1.01	0.89	
	SC3	4.60	1.04	1.67	−1.00	0.92	
	SC4	4.57	1.06	1.30	−0.94	0.90	
	SC5	4.67	1.02	1.77	−1.00	0.91	
Help-based pride	HB1	4.69	1.01	2.14	−1.12	0.90	0.96
	HB2	4.69	1.01	2.06	−1.10	0.94	
	HB3	4.64	1.01	1.91	−1.08	0.90	
	HB4	4.68	1.00	2.07	−1.12	0.93	
	HB5	4.69	1.00	1.86	−1.06	0.90	
Ideal L2 self	IS1	3.51	1.28	−0.81	−0.23	0.74	0.93
	IS2	3.31	1.29	−0.89	−0.08	0.82	
	IS3	3.54	1.30	−0.75	−0.28	0.88	
	IS4	4.17	1.25	0.11	−0.76	0.81	
	IS5	3.72	1.28	−0.58	−0.41	0.91	
	IS6	3.84	1.28	−0.36	−0.51	0.87	
Ought-to L2 self	OS1	3.42	1.28	−0.79	−0.10	0.58	0.88
	OS2	3.86	1.22	−0.40	−0.46	0.66	
	OS3	3.83	1.19	−0.22	−0.51	0.84	
	OS4	3.71	1.19	−0.27	−0.42	0.83	
	OS5	3.88	1.15	0.10	−0.62	0.81	
	OS6	3.57	1.20	−0.44	−0.28	0.79	
Form-focused IDLE	F1	3.57	1.24	−0.604	−0.30	0.81	0.93
	F2	3.76	1.20	−0.321	−0.49	0.85	
	F3	3.78	1.17	−0.184	−0.53	0.87	
	F4	3.69	1.18	−0.338	−0.44	0.88	
	F5	3.52	1.18	−0.59	−0.24	0.84	
	F6	4.24	1.16	0.587	−0.85	0.68	
	F7	3.75	1.15	−0.162	−0.47	0.80	
Meaning-focused IDLE	M1	3.83	1.18	−0.137	−0.54	0.72	0.92
	M2	3.34	1.19	−0.651	−0.02	0.85	
	M3	3.06	1.23	−0.709	0.23	0.83	

(Continues)

TABLE 1 | (Continued)

Factors	Items	Mean	SD	Kurtosis	Skewness	Factor loading (In CFA)	α (>0.7)
	M4	3.30	1.22	−0.732	−0.07	0.88	
	M5	3.11	1.23	−0.664	0.23	0.85	
	M6	4.07	1.19	0.152	−0.66	0.59	
	M7	3.45	1.20	−0.537	−0.16	0.76	

TABLE 2 | Convergent and discriminant validity of L2 pride, L2 motivation, and IDLE.

		AVE (>0.5)	CR (>0.7)	The square root of AVE and squared correlation coefficient matrix			
				1	2	3	4
1	Pride	0.76	0.98	0.87			
2	Ideal L2 self	0.71	0.94	0.37	0.84		
3	Ought L2 self	0.57	0.89	0.35	0.44	0.76	
4	IDLE	0.59	0.95	0.37	0.60	0.44	0.77

Note: The bolded values along the diagonal represent the square root of AVE.

TABLE 3 | Model fit indices of L2 pride, L2 motivation, and IDLE.

	χ^2/df	CFI	IFI	TLI	NFI	PGFI	RMSEA	SRMR
The measurement model	5.26	0.94	0.94	0.94	0.93	0.75	0.06	0.06
The structural model	5.55	0.94	0.94	0.93	0.92	0.83	0.06	0.076
Benchmark values (Kline 2023)	<5	>0.9	>0.9	>0.9	>0.9	>0.5	<0.10	<0.08

on IDLE (H1: $\beta = 0.13$, $p < 0.001$, $t\text{-value} = 4.51$), ideal L2 self (H2: $\beta = 0.38$, $p < 0.001$, $t\text{-value} = 13.39$), and ought-to L2 self (H3: $\beta = 0.37$, $p < 0.001$, $t\text{-value} = 12.82$). Ideal L2 self exerted a predictive effect on IDLE (H4: $\beta = 0.53$, $p < 0.001$, $t\text{-value} = 16.68$) in a positive and significant manner. Ought-to L2 self could also predict IDLE positively and significantly (H5: $\beta = 0.21$, $p < 0.001$, $t\text{-value} = 7.56$). Examination of the R^2 values in Figure 2 revealed that L2 pride explained 14% of the variance in ideal L2 self and 13% of the variance in ought-to L2 self. Together, these three variables (L2 pride, ideal L2 self, and ought-to L2 self) accounted for 45% of the variance in IDLE participation. According to benchmarks established for L2 research (Plonsky and Oswald 2014), these R^2 values and the correlation coefficients (r) (see Table 4) jointly demonstrated moderate-to-strong effect sizes for all five hypothesized relationships (Plonsky and Oswald 2014), which indicate substantial explanatory power of the structural model.

Considering there existed mediating variables (i.e., ideal L2 self and ought-to self), we conducted mediation tests to investigate the indirect associations between L2 pride and IDLE by adhering to the steps recommended by Collier (2020). We calculated a bootstrapped analysis with 2000 samples and a 95% confidence interval in Amos. As disclosed in Table 5, it was unveiled that the ideal L2 self can play a partial mediating role between L2 pride and IDLE (lower bound = 0.17, upper bound = 0.24, $p < 0.001$) and the indirect impact of L2 pride on IDLE could be partially

mediated by ought-to L2 self (lower bound = 0.05, upper bound = 0.11, $p < 0.001$) because the lower and upper bounds of two mediating paths exceeded zero and their indirect effects were both significant (Collier 2020).

5 | Discussion and Implications

This SEM study examined the predictive relationships between L2 pride, L2 motivation, and IDLE participation among Chinese university EFL learners. Based on the hypothesis testing results and mediation analyses, four key findings should be discussed to comprehensively address the one core research question: In what ways, if any, does L2 pride interplay with L2 motivation to predict EFL learners' participation in IDLE?

The first key finding of this study indicates that L2 pride directly and positively predicted EFL learners' participation in IDLE (H1: L2 pride $\rightarrow$ IDLE, $\beta = 0.13$, $p < 0.001$, $t\text{-value} = 4.51$, $r = 0.37$). This finding aligned with previous research highlighting the predictive role of L2 pride in language learning behaviors and academic engagement (Derakhshan and Yin 2024; Gatbonton and Trofimovich 2008; Yang and Li 2024). The medium effect size ($r = 0.37$; Plonsky and Ghanbar 2018) further supported the notion that learners with higher levels of L2 pride are more likely to invest time and effort in technology-mediated language learning beyond

TABLE 4 | Hypotheses testing results of direct paths.

Hypotheses	β	p	t -value (>1.96)	r	Results
H1: L2 pride $\rightarrow$ IDLE	0.13***	$p < 0.001$	4.51	0.37	Supported
H2: L2 pride $\rightarrow$ Ideal L2 self	0.38***	$p < 0.001$	13.39	0.37	Supported
H3: L2 pride $\rightarrow$ Ought-to L2 self	0.37***	$p < 0.001$	12.82	0.35	Supported
H4: Ideal L2 self $\rightarrow$ IDLE	0.53***	$p < 0.001$	16.68	0.60	Supported
H5: Ought-to L2 self $\rightarrow$ IDLE	0.21***	$p < 0.001$	7.56	0.44	Supported

Note: $r > 0.5$ = large effect size, while $0.5 > r > 0.25$ = medium effect size (Plonsky and Ghanbar 2018).

*** $p < 0.001$.

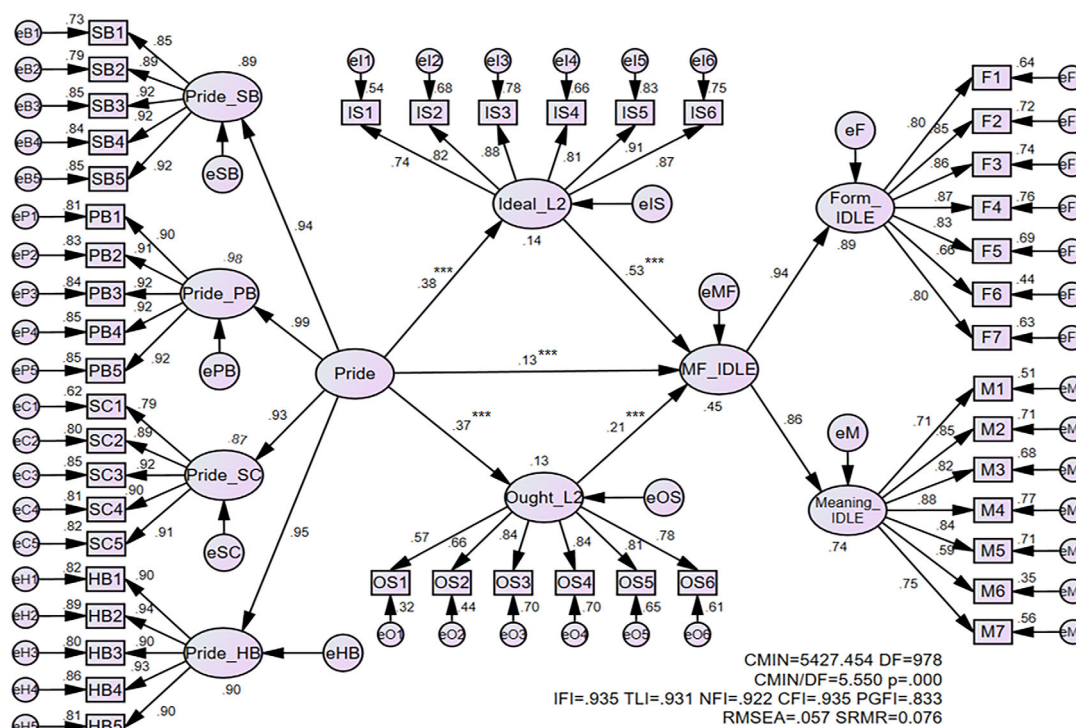


FIGURE 2 | The structural equation model of L2 pride, L2 motivation, and IDLE. [Color figure can be viewed at wileyonlinelibrary.com]

TABLE 5 | Mediation paths results.

Mediation paths	95% Confidence interval		p (two-tailed significance)	Indirect effect	Results
	Lower bound	Upper bound			
L2 pride $\rightarrow$ Ideal L2 self $\rightarrow$ IDLE	0.17	0.24	$p < 0.001$	0.20	Partial mediation
L2 pride $\rightarrow$ Ought-to L2 self $\rightarrow$ IDLE	0.05	0.11	$p < 0.001$	0.08	Partial mediation

*** $p < 0.001$.

the classroom. Additionally, this finding extended the existing literature, which underscored the significance of affective factors in facilitating successful IDLE participation (Lee and Drajeti 2019; Lee and Lee 2020; Liu et al. 2024). In particular, the significant direct relationship between L2 pride and IDLE highlighted the role of emotional preparedness as a crucial individual difference variable in shaping learners' engagement in IDLE activities (Lai et al. 2015; Liu and Darvin 2024; Soyoof et al. 2023).

The second key finding revealed that L2 pride exerted a positive and direct influence on both components of L2 motivation—the ideal L2 self and the ought-to L2 self. This finding was consistent with previous research highlighting the role of positive emotions in the motivational development of L2 learners (MacIntyre and Vincze 2017; Ross and Stracke 2016; Szyner and Cohen 2021; Utz and Muscanell 2018). While prior studies have explored the relationship between pride and motivation in general education

and social psychology (e.g., Gathbonton and Trofimovich 2008; Utz and Muscanell 2018), the present study specifically sheds light on the significant influence of L2 pride on both promotion-focused and prevention-focused motivation in extramural learning contexts. This relationship was evidenced by the strong predictive effects observed in the study (H2: L2 pride $\rightarrow$ ideal L2 self, $\beta = 0.38$, $p < 0.001$, t -value = 13.39, $r = 0.37$; H3: L2 pride $\rightarrow$ ought-to L2 self, $\beta = 0.37$, $p < 0.001$, t -value = 12.82, $r = 0.35$), with medium effect sizes for both the ideal and ought-to L2 selves. These findings suggested that learners with high levels of L2 pride were more likely to engage in English learning activities that aligned with their aspirations, thereby working to reduce the discrepancy between their actual and ideal L2 selves (Buechner et al. 2016; Gathbonton and Trofimovich 2008). Furthermore, within the Chinese EFL context, L2 pride appears to be closely associated with fulfilling societal and parental expectations regarding English proficiency (Derakhshan and Yin 2024; Yang and Li 2024). Learners who take pride in their English competence tend to perceive themselves as meeting external L2 standards, thereby reinforcing their ought-to L2 selves.

The third key finding concerned the strong relationship between components of L2 motivation and participation in IDLE. Specifically, learners' ideal L2 selves significantly and positively predicted their engagement with digital technologies for extramural English learning (H4: ideal L2 self $\rightarrow$ IDLE, $\beta = 0.53$, $p < 0.001$, t -value = 16.68, $r = 0.60$). This finding aligned with previous research indicating that Chinese university EFL students with stronger internalized and integrative motivation exhibit a greater willingness to engage in technology-mediated informal learning, as intrinsic motives play a crucial role in sustaining autonomous learning behaviors in digital environments (Liu et al. 2024). These results suggested that the ideal L2 self, particularly aspirations for self-improvement, served as a primary motivational driver of proactive IDLE participation. Additionally, the study demonstrated that the ought-to L2 self, which encompassed failure avoidance and external group expectations, also positively predicted IDLE participation (H5: ought-to L2 self $\rightarrow$ IDLE, $\beta = 0.21$, $p < 0.001$, t -value = 7.56, $r = 0.44$). This finding contrasted with previous studies suggesting that the ought-to L2 self lacked direct predictive power over IDLE engagement due to potential mediating variables (e.g., Lee and Lu 2023; Li et al. 2022; Liu et al. 2024, Liu et al. 2024c). A possible explanation for this novel finding may be the increasing importance of English proficiency in Chinese academic and professional contexts (Li 2020). Under growing external pressures and societal expectations, students are increasingly motivated to seek additional learning opportunities through digital platforms, even in informal settings.

Finally, the study disclosed that both the ideal L2 self and the ought-to L2 self served as partial mediators in the relationship between L2 pride and IDLE participation. Significant indirect effects of L2 pride on IDLE engagement were observed through these two motivational constructs, aligning with previous research suggesting that learners' language learning behaviors were substantially shaped by intrinsic emotional pride, whether derived from self-satisfaction or social recognition (Barabadi and Khajavy 2020; Derakhshan and Yin 2024; Gathbonton and Trofimovich 2008; Yang and Li 2024). These findings indicated that the influence of L2 pride on technology-mediated informal English learning operates through multiple pathways.

Learners who experience higher levels of L2 pride not only exhibit a greater propensity for IDLE participation but also develop stronger ideal and ought-to L2 selves, which, in turn, sustain their engagement in informal digital learning environments. Thus, the partial mediating roles of these motivational constructs provided further insight into how Chinese EFL learners' pride shaped their involvement in self-directed language learning activities. This finding was consistent with Yang and Li's (2024) observations on the importance of individual characteristics—such as academic achievement, social validation, and external encouragement—in technology-enhanced language learning contexts. In this regard, the present study highlighted the crucial role of motivational dynamics in explaining how the effects of pride were transmitted into informal learning behaviors in digital settings.

Building on these insights, several pedagogical implications can be drawn from this study. **First**, given the role of L2 pride as a stable and enduring affective motivator in facilitating language learning within technology-enhanced environments, it is essential for educators and language instructors to cultivate L2 pride by creating opportunities for students to showcase their English proficiency. Such opportunities can help instill confidence, reinforce learners' self-perception as competent L2 users, and further enhance their motivation. For instance, classroom presentations, collaborative projects, and speech competitions could be organized, allowing students to demonstrate their language abilities, receive social recognition, and celebrate their achievements. These initiatives not only promote the development of L2 pride but also foster a stronger sense of ownership over the language learning process. **Second**, in light of the significant influence of L2 pride on both the ideal L2 self and the ought-to L2 self, exposure to diverse role models of successful English users may serve as a valuable strategy for expanding learners' possible ideal L2 selves. For example, creating online forums and seminars to invite L2 role models to share their IDLE activities in the language learning journey. Meanwhile, while nurturing learners' pride, educators should seek to reframe ought-to L2 expectations as opportunities for personal growth and skill mastery rather than as imposed obligations. By adopting this perspective, learners may be better equipped to capitalize on technological affordances in extramural language learning activities, thereby maximizing the potential of IDLE for their language development. **Third**, given the indirect and positive effect of L2 pride on IDLE activities through the ideal L2 self, teachers should consider constructing a supportive and amiable community to encourage learners to envision themselves as proficient English users in diverse language settings and help them figure out a clear and vivid ideal L2 self-image. For example, organizing role-playing activities where students assume the roles of proficient English speakers in real-life scenarios, such as job interviews or social gatherings. In addition, educators and teachers can encourage learners to assess their progress related to their ideal L2 selves regularly (e.g., individual goals) and ought-to L2 selves (e.g., expectations from society or parents), which can be achieved by facilitating self-reflection and self-evaluation. For instance, using self-assessment tools, such as checklists, which evaluate students' performance and help them identify areas for improvement. This encouragement can motivate students to invest their efforts in the extramural language learning environment, thereby persisting in their affective experience. **Fourth**, teachers may assist students in discovering online resources (e.g., podcasts and TEDtalk) and exploring various

IDLE activities (e.g., watching English vlogs involved in traveling or shopping) that align with their personal interests, learning preferences, achievement goals, and aspirations, which can help students view involvement in IDLE practices as a valuable and rewarding endeavor, thus sustaining this positive attitude and language learning behaviors. **Lastly**, teachers may nurture a supportive language learning atmosphere that celebrates students' efforts and phrased progress, not just underscore language grade and performance, which could increase their positivity of developing L2 competence and make them proud of English learning achievement. For instance, providing regular, constructive feedback that acknowledges students' efforts and progress, modeling positive attitudes toward language learning, and sharing experiences of overcoming language learning challenges.

6 | Conclusion

This study investigated the interplay between L2 pride, L2 motivation (ideal L2 self and ought-to L2 self), and IDLE participation among Chinese university EFL learners. The research offers two key contributions: it illuminates the complex role of L2 pride—an understudied construct—in extramural learning practices, and it provides theoretical insights into how motivational and affective dimensions interact in technology-mediated, self-directed language learning. Several limitations of this study suggest directions for future research. The cross-sectional design precluded observation of how participants' L2 pride and motivation evolve over time, limiting our understanding of the longitudinal development of these factors during IDLE participation. Future studies employing longitudinal designs could better capture these developmental dynamics. While this research focused on L2 pride, investigation of other understudied emotions such as shyness and shame, and their interaction with motivational variables in digital language learning environments, could provide a more comprehensive understanding of emotional–motivational dynamics in IDLE practices. Additionally, expanding the scope to examine environmental factors and their influence on emotions, motivation, and IDLE engagement would more fully elucidate the control-value theory. Finally, given this study's quantitative approach, future research using mixed-methods designs could offer deeper insights into the complex mechanisms underlying learners' affective and motivational factors in informal digital learning contexts.

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Ethics Statement

This study was conducted in accordance with the ethical guidelines. The research protocol was approved by the Institutional Review Board of Hunan University of Science and Technology. All participants provided informed consent before participating in the study.

Conflicts of Interest

The authors declare that they have no known competing interests that could have appeared to influence the work reported in this paper.

Data Availability Statement

The raw data can be made available upon request.

Peer Review

The peer review history for this article is available at <https://publons.com/publon/10.1111/ijal.12738>

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Appendix

A. L2 Pride Scale (Khajavy and Lüftenegger, 2024)

(20-item scale, Likert 6-point) (1 Strongly disagree–6 Strongly agree)

Self-based pride

Definition: Self-based pride denotes the sense of self-worth and accomplishment an individual derives from their personal growth and progress in the L2 acquisition process.

SB1	I am proud when I can speak English with foreigners better than before. 当我能比以前更好地与外国人说英语时,我感到非常自豪。
SB2	I am proud when I get higher grades in the English exams than before. 当我在英语考试中取得比以前更高的成绩时,我感到非常自豪。
SB3	I am proud when I give more correct answers to my English teacher's questions. 当我对英语老师的问题给出更多正确答案时,我很自豪。
SB4	I am proud when I understand an English-language movie/news/series without subtitles better than before. 当我能比以前更好地理解一部没有字幕的英语电影/新闻/连续剧时,我感到非常自豪。
SB5	I am proud when I speak English more fluently in the classroom than before. 当我在课堂上比以前说得更流利时,我感到非常自豪。

Praise-based pride

Definition: Praise-based pride refers to the feeling of self-worth that arises when an individual receives public recognition and accolades from others, which in turn fosters perseverance and effort investment in L2 learning.

PB1	I am proud when my classmates praise me. 当同学们称赞我时,我很自豪。
PB2	I am proud when I get the attention of my English teacher and classmates. 当我得到英语老师和同学们的关注时,我很自豪。
PB3	I am proud when my family praises me for my knowledge/mastery of English. 当家人称赞我懂英语/精通英语时,我感到非常自豪。
PB4	I am proud when my English teacher is satisfied with my performance in the English class. 如果英语老师对我在英语课上的表现感到满意,我就会感到自豪。
PB5	I am proud when my English teacher praises me in the classroom. 当英语老师在课堂上表扬我时,我很自豪。

Social comparison-based pride

Definition: Social comparison-based pride represents the sense of pride an individual experiences when they outperform their peers in the L2 acquisition process.

SC1	I am proud when I know English better than my family members do. 当我比家人更懂英语时,我很自豪。
SC2	I am proud when I'm the only person who can answer a question in English class. 当我是英语课上唯一能回答问题的人时,我很自豪。
SC3	I am proud when I can answer a question sooner than others in English class. 在英语课上,如果我能比别人更快回答问题,我就会感到自豪。
SC4	I am proud when I can speak English better than my classmates. 当我的英语说得比同学好时,我就会感到自豪。
SC5	I am proud when I get the highest grade in an exam among my classmates in the English class. 在英语课上,当我的考试成绩在同学中名列前茅时,我感到非常自豪。

(Continues)

Help-based pride

Definition: Help-based pride is conceptualized as the sense of pride an individual derives from assisting others or engaging in prosocial behaviors within the context of L2 learning.

HB1	I am proud when I can help my family members who need help with understanding English materials. 当我能帮助需要帮助的家人理解英语材料时,我感到非常自豪。
HB2	I am proud when I can help my classmates in their English courses. 当我能在英语课程中帮助同学时,我感到非常自豪。
HB3	I am proud when I can help my classmates whose proficiency level is lower than mine. 当我能帮助水平比我低的同学时,我感到很自豪。
HB4	I am proud when I share an important point about English with my English language classmates so that they could also benefit from it. 当我与我的英语同学分享有关英语的重要观点,让他们也能从中受益时,我感到非常自豪。
HB5	I am proud when I can help someone who does not know English well (e.g., by translating a text). 当我能帮助不熟悉英语的人时(例如,通过翻译文本),我感到很自豪。

B. L2 Motivation Scale (Dornyei, 2009; You et al., 2016)

(12-item scale, Likert 6-point) (1 Strongly disagree—6 Strongly agree)

Ideal L2 self

Definition: Ideal L2 self represents the motives growing out of personal desires for growth, accomplishments, and positive outcomes associated with learning English.

IS1	Whenever I think about my future career, I imagine myself using English. 每当我想到我未来的职业时,我都会想象自己在使用英语。
IS2	I can imagine myself doing business with foreigners through English. 我可以想象我与外国人通过英语交流做生意的场景。
IS3	I can imagine myself speaking English with international friends or colleagues. 我可以想象自己与国际朋友或同事说英语。
IS4	I can imagine myself as a person who is able to speak English. 我可以想象自己是一个能够说英语的人。
IS5	I can imagine myself talking in English with foreign friends in informal situations in the future. 我可以想象自己将来在非正式场合上和外国朋友用英语交谈的情形。
IS6	I can imagine myself having discussions in English when living or traveling abroad. 我可以想象自己在国外生活或旅行时用英语进行讨论。

Ought-to L2 self

Definition: Ought-to L2 self comprises the motives related to the attempts to meet external expectations and avoid negative consequences that may arise from not learning English.

OS1	If I don't learn English, it will have a negative impact on my life. 如果我不学英语,这会对我的生活产生负面影响。
OS2	Learning English is important to me because people around me think I should learn it. 学英语对我来说很重要,因为我身边的人认为我应该学好它。
OS3	Learning English is important to me because it will give me social recognition. 学英语对我来说很重要,因为这样可以获得社会的认可。
OS4	Learning English is important to me because I want to gain recognition from my teachers and classmates. 学英语对我来说很重要,因为我想获得老师同学对我的认可。
OS5	Learning English is important to me because an educated person should be able to use English. 学英语对我来说很重要,因为一个受过教育的人应该能够使用英语。
OS6	Learning English is important to me because other people will respect me more if I have knowledge of English. 学英语对我来说是重要,因为如果我有英语知识,其他人会更尊重我。

C. Form-Focused and Meaning-Focused Informal Digital Learning of English Scale (FM-IDLES) Bilingual Version

(14-item scale, Likert 6-point) (1 Strongly disagree–6 Strongly agree)

Form-focused informal digital learning of English activities (FIA)

Definition: FIA refers to out-of-class and technology-mediated English learning activities that primarily target the formal aspects of language, such as grammar, vocabulary, pronunciation, and sentence structure.

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|----|---|
| F1 | I actively listen to English news or podcasts on my mobile phone or computer outside class to improve my English listening skills.
我在课外主动用手机或电脑听英语新闻或播客, 提高英语听力水平。 |
| F2 | I actively use English learning apps to practice my oral expression and improve my English-speaking skills outside the classroom.
我在课外主动使用英语学习App练习口语表达, 提升英语口语能力。 |
| F3 | I actively use English learning apps to practice and improve my English pronunciation outside the classroom.
我在课外主动使用英语学习App练习和提升我的英语发音。 |
| F4 | I actively improve my English reading skills by reading English articles/contents through online resources outside the classroom.
我在课外主动通过网络资源阅读英语文章/内容来提升我的英语阅读能力。 |
| F5 | I actively use mobile phone apps or websites for online English writing practice outside of class to improve my English writing skills.
我在课外主动使用手机应用或网站进行在线英语写作练习, 提升英语写作能力。 |
| F6 | I actively use vocabulary apps outside of class to expand my English vocabulary.
我在课外主动使用词汇App来拓展我的英语词汇量。 |
| F7 | I actively use mobile phone apps or websites to learn English grammar outside of class.
我在课外主动使用手机App或网站来学习英语语法。 |

Meaning-focused informal digital learning of English activities (MIA)

Definition: MIA involves out-of-class and technology-mediated English learning that emphasizes comprehension, communication, and the practical application of language in real-life contexts.

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|----|---|
| M1 | I actively watch short English videos (e.g., vlogs) on social media outside the classroom.
我在课外主动观看社交媒体上的英语短视频(如vlog)。 |
| M2 | I actively communicate with other learners in English through social media apps outside the classroom.
我在课外主动通过社交媒体软件与其他学习者用英语交流。 |
| M3 | I actively chat with foreigners in English through social media software outside the classroom.
我在课外主动通过社交媒体软件与外国人用英语聊天。 |
| M4 | I actively read English articles online or English-related posts on social media.
我在主动阅读网上的英语文章或社交媒体上跟英语相关的帖子。 |
| M5 | I actively participate in online English discussion platforms to discuss with others on topics that are currently popular or familiar to me.
我主动参与在线英文讨论平台, 与他人讨论当前热门或者我熟悉的话题。 |
| M6 | I actively watch English-language films and TV series outside the classroom.
我在课外主动观看英语电影和电视剧。 |
| M7 | I actively search online (either in Chinese or English) to learn about the culture and history of English-speaking countries/languages to develop my intercultural communication skills.
我在网上主动查询(不论用中文或者英文)了解英语国家/语言的文化和历史, 来拓展我的跨文化交流能力。 |